

Last time we introduced the question of what we should believe. We began by considering this rule of belief:

No Proof $\rightarrow$ No Belief

If you can't give a good
argument for P, don't
believe P.

But we saw that this led to the result that you should not believe anything at all, which seems very implausible.

At the very least, it seems, we should believe things that we can be certain of:

Certainty $\rightarrow$ Belief

If you can rule out any situation which would make P false, you should believe P.

Experience → Belief

If your sense experience tells you that P, and you have no reason to think that your sense experience is misleading, you should believe P.

Proof $\rightarrow$ Belief

If you can prove
P, you should
believe P.

This is a version of a view known as foundationalism.

It can be summed up with the following negative rule of belief:

No Foundations → No Belief

If you can't be certain that P and your senses don't tell you that P and you can't give a good argument for P, you should not believe P.

We can now put that second argument in a more precise form.

1. We have no sensory experience of God.
2. You can't be certain that God exists.
3. We have no good argument for the existence of God.
4. If you can't be certain that P and your senses don't tell you that P and you don't have a good argument for P, you should not believe P.

C. You should not believe in God. (1,2,3,4)

THE EVIDENTIALIST ARGUMENT AGAINST BELIEF IN GOD

One might of course reject premise (3), if you found one of the arguments for the existence of God we discussed in class convincing. And you might reject (1) if you have had certain kinds of mystical experiences.

But many religious believers have not had mystical experiences, and don't take themselves to be in possession of good arguments for God's existence. For them, the belief that God exists is a **basic belief** despite not fitting into either of the two categories of basic belief allowed by foundationalism.

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The first part of the paper discusses the importance of understanding the cultural context of the research. It highlights the need for researchers to be sensitive to the values and beliefs of the communities they are studying. This is particularly important in the field of education, where cultural differences can significantly impact learning outcomes and classroom management. The author argues that a one-size-fits-all approach to education is not only ineffective but also disrespectful to the diverse cultures of our students.

In the second part, the author explores the role of the teacher as a cultural mediator. Teachers are not just transmitters of knowledge; they are also responsible for creating a safe and inclusive environment where all students can thrive. This requires a deep understanding of the cultural backgrounds of their students and the ability to adapt their teaching practices accordingly. The author provides several examples of how teachers can use culturally responsive strategies to engage their students and foster a love of learning.

The third part of the paper focuses on the importance of family and community involvement in the educational process. The author emphasizes that education is not just a school-based activity; it is a shared responsibility that involves parents, teachers, and the community. By building strong partnerships with families and the community, schools can better support their students and address the unique challenges they face. The author concludes by calling for a more holistic approach to education that recognizes the cultural richness of our students and the power of community to transform lives.

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Don't → No Belief

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Proof $\rightarrow$ Belief

dislike it.

If you can prove P ,

Let's take stock. We've not considered three

candidate rules of belief.

surely, one might think, there must be some

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principles which explain why certain beliefs are

We've seen that both of our 'no belief'

principles are open to substantial challenge. But

One way to underline the force of the evidentialist argument is to use the

example of the world's fastest growing religions: Pastafarianism.













































































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